

Mathan Kumar

Senior Guidewire Developer | Guidewire Certified Integration Specialist (PolicyCenter · ClaimCenter · BillingCenter)

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Professional Summary

Senior software engineer with 14+ years of experience in insurance technology and deep expertise across the Guidewire ecosystem, including PolicyCenter, ClaimCenter and BillingCenter. Guidewire Certified Integration Specialist in InsuranceSuite 10.0 and Elysian, with hands-on experience in Gosu development, Edge API integrations, workflow automation and enterprise modernisation. Proven success designing integrations between Guidewire and digital platforms using Azure API Management and REST/SOAP services and migrating Guidewire business rules to Java/Spring Boot microservices. Led an initiative that reduced quote-processing latency by approximately **73%, from 8.2 to 2.2 seconds**. Currently leads and mentors an engineering team at Hastings Direct while delivering complex Guidewire modernisation and digital integration programmes.

Core Technical Skills

- **Guidewire Platform:** Full Suite — PolicyCenter, ClaimCenter, BillingCenter, ContactManager (versions 8, 9 & 10.x, incl. Elysian), Gosu scripting, PCF configuration, GX Model/payload generation, Edge API integration layer, plugin-based customization framework, activity/workflow automation, batch processing, event messaging, inbound file integration, Guidewire Studio (IntelliJ-based IDE)
- **Integration & Middleware:** Azure API Management (policy-driven gateway design, protocol transformation, circuit-breaker/kill-switch patterns, reusable policy modules), JWT/OAuth2, REST & SOAP web services, multi-brand authentication/CORS configuration
- **Backend Engineering:** Java (8–17)/J2EE, Spring Boot, Spring MVC, Maven multi-module architecture, microservices design, concurrent/parallel processing, data structures & algorithms
- **Cloud & DevOps:** Microsoft Azure (APIM, Application Insights), Docker, Azure DevOps & GitHub Actions CI/CD
- **Frontend:** React (16–19), TypeScript, Redux Toolkit/RTK Query, redux-saga, React Router, Context API, styled-components, i18next
- **Quality Engineering:** JUnit 5, Mockito, AssertJ, JaCoCo, Jest, React Testing Library, Postman, SQL & PL/SQL

Certifications

Certification	Issuer	Date
Guidewire Certified Specialist – InsuranceSuite Integration (Elysian)	Guidewire Software	Dec 2023
Specialist Certification – InsuranceSuite 10.0 Integration	Guidewire Software	Aug 2019
Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)	Microsoft	Dec 2022
Microsoft Certified: Azure Data Fundamentals (DP-900)	Microsoft	Dec 2022
Docker Foundations Professional Certificate	Docker, Inc.	Jul 2025
Learning GitHub Actions	LinkedIn Learning	Jul 2025
Java Foundations Professional Certificate	JetBrains	Dec 2025

Professional Experience

Hastings Direct — Bexhill, UK

Jun 2020 – Present, 6 yrs 3+ months

Senior Software Engineer – Guidewire Platform Modernisation Lead

Dec 2025 – Present

- Leading the modernization of Hastings Direct's motor-insurance quoting platform, migrating the central quote-orchestration logic — previously implemented in Guidewire PolicyCenter (Gosu) — into a Java/Spring Boot orchestration service that now sits at the core of the platform, preserving full business-rule parity with the legacy system
- The service receives quote requests over SOAP from two distinct channels — Guidewire itself (call-centre new business, renewals, and mid-term adjustments) and price-comparison aggregators (Private Car and Motorcycle direct quotes) — fans each request out to five specialised downstream microservices (validation, enrichment, insurer pricing, retail pricing, and search/retrieve), and aggregates the results into a single response
- Re-architected the orchestration flow to run these downstream calls concurrently rather than sequentially, cutting end-to-end quote latency by ~73% (8.2s → 2.2s)
- Built in resilience and traceability by design: correlation-ID propagation across every downstream call, asynchronous request/response persistence that never blocks the quote pipeline, and graceful degradation so a failed renewal quote returns safely rather than surfacing an error back to Guidewire

- Own the platform's integration with core pricing partners — Polaris (insurer risk pricing/scoring) and Earnix (retail pricing) — and champion 100%-test-coverage and automated quality-gate discipline across the team
- Line-manage and mentor a team of engineers; contribute to platform-wide architecture decisions

Senior Development Analyst — Guidewire PolicyCenter Developer

Jun 2020 – Feb 2023

- Owned the end-to-end aggregator new-business quote journey in Guidewire PolicyCenter: retrieving a quote generated on an external price-comparison platform and converting it into a PolicyCenter Account, Submission, and multi-brand set of Policy Periods, triggered directly from the quote search screen
- Built the automatic rerate logic that detects a stale or expired aggregator quote on retrieval and transparently re-prices it through Guidewire's rating engine before presenting it to the underwriter or customer, rather than surfacing out-of-date figures
- Implemented the web-service integration between the aggregator quote database and PolicyCenter, including the product-specific mapping logic (Private Car, Home, Motorcycle, Commercial Van) that carries pricing, discount, commission, and tax data from the pricing partners (Polaris/Earnix) into the policy record
- Designed the concurrent multi-version rating step that prices every competing brand/scheme quote in parallel through Guidewire's rating engine, followed by automated underwriting-referral evaluation
- Diagnosed and fixed a cost-data mapping defect where certain fee amounts on Private Car quotes were displaying without their worksheet breakdown, aligning it with an existing fallback already used for Motorcycle

React Developer

Feb 2023 – Dec 2025

- Delivered a React/TypeScript self-service digital claims platform (Total Loss and Repair journeys), integrating with Guidewire ClaimCenter through an Azure API Management gateway rather than Guidewire's native UI
- Designed and maintained the Azure APIM integration layer fronting ClaimCenter: translating Guidewire's native protocol into clean REST APIs for the frontend, enforcing authentication across three consumer brands, and building a kill-switch mechanism to safely take the service offline without a redeploy
- Implemented a structured web-analytics/event-tracking layer (custom event emitter feeding a GTM-style data layer) and delivered full Jest/React Testing Library unit coverage

Senior Development Analyst — Guidewire ClaimCenter Developer

Feb 2023 – Dec 2025

- Developed Gosu-based backend services on ClaimCenter's Edge API layer, extending Guidewire's standard plugin framework with Hastings-specific business rules while preserving out-of-the-box platform behaviour
- Built the Total Loss valuation service consumed by the digital claims platform — calculating settlement figures (market value, adjustments, excess, finance/lease payouts) and handling the policyholders accept/reject decision end-to-end, including automated payment triggering
- Designed the claims activity and workflow automation for Total Loss cases: automatically raising the right customer actions (photo upload, finance documents, bank details, licence checks), chasing unresponsive customers, and generating review summaries for the claims team
- Contributed to First Notification of Loss (FNOL) claim intake processing, including claim registration, location geocoding, and automated claim closure for notification-only cases

LV= — Specialist Integration Engineer (Contract)

Nov 2019 – May 2020

Contracted as a specialist integration engineer at one of the UK's largest insurers, delivering full-stack data integration solutions across core insurance platforms.

- Designed and built API integrations (REST and SOAP) between core policy management systems and external aggregator platforms, handling complex data transformation and business rule enforcement
- Implemented end-to-end integrations across billing and policy systems, writing well-structured, maintainable backend code in Java and Gosu
- Produced technical documentation

EY — Technical Manager

Nov 2014 – Nov 2019

Client: ALFA Insurance Corporation (Alabama, Georgia & Mississippi, US) — Guidewire full-suite implementation

- Delivered a full-suite Guidewire implementation (PolicyCenter, BillingCenter, ClaimCenter, ContactManager — versions 8, 9 & 10.x) for ALFA Insurance Corporation, enabling the client to manage millions of customers' insurance details across Business Owners, Property, and Personal Auto lines
- Drove a wide range of platform customizations across the full Guidewire suite and automated communication between multiple downstream systems, removing manual effort from the client's insurance operations
- Owned the responsibility of delivering an automatic bulk invoice processing, FNOL creation, ISO integration, SIMSOL
- Technologies: Guidewire Gosu, Java/J2EE, data structures, SQL & PL/SQL, Guidewire Studio (IntelliJ-based IDE)

Additional Experience (Pre-Guidewire)

- IGATE — Senior Software Engineer | Jan 2014 – Nov 2014 — Gathered client requirements and implemented cross-cutting solutions using Spring MVC, PL/SQL, JBoss, and AWS S3.
- Tech Mahindra — Software Engineer | Jun 2011 – Dec 2013 — Early software engineering foundation role.

Projects

ShopFlow — Multi-Tenant Retail SaaS Platform (shopflow.uk)

Personal project — sole architect, developer, and operator (backend, frontend, infrastructure, deployment)

- Designed and built a multi-tenant SaaS platform enabling independent shops to sell online via their own subdomain storefront with tenant isolation, role-based access across shop-admin/customer/super-admin tiers, and stateless JWT authentication
- **Backend:** Java 21, Spring Boot 3.2, Spring Data JPA, Spring Security, PostgreSQL with Flyway-versioned schema migrations, layered controller→service→repository architecture, springdoc-openapi/Swagger documentation
- **Frontend:** React 19, Vite, TypeScript, TanStack Query, Zustand, React Hook Form + Zod, Tailwind CSS
- **Cloud/Infra:** Cloudflare Pages hosting the frontend; a custom Cloudflare Worker rewriting subdomain-to-tenant identity in the request path; Cloudflare R2 object storage with presigned direct-to-bucket uploads (AWS SDK v2) and on-the-fly image resizing/WebP conversion; Docker Compose deployment (Spring Boot API + PostgreSQL) on a self-managed VPS behind Cloudflare DNS/CDN
- Owns the product end-to-end — from DNS/SSL configuration to database schema evolution to production monitoring — with no platform or ops team

Education

Anna University — Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech.), Information Technology (2007 – 2011)